Arijit (Ari) D. Sen

ari_sen@berkeley.edu 828-318-5400

Experience

Scientific American

Data Editor — January 2026 - Present.

- Built a custom graph-based RAG A.I. search tool to examine Jeffrey Epstein's ties to scientists

CBS News

Investigative Data Journalist — February 2024 - Dec. 2025.

- Spearheaded an investigation into criminal police officers who work off-duty jobs, juggling stakeholders from around the country.
- Built tools to track mass shootings, Olympic and Paralympic medals and ransomware attacks at schools.

The Dallas Morning News

Computational Journalist — June 2022 - February 2024; *Contract Investigative Reporter* — August 2021 - June 2022; *Data & Investigative Intern* – June 2021 - August 2021.

- Served as the main data reporter on a IRE Award-winning and Livingston finalist series on preventable trauma deaths.
- Authored a two-part investigative series revealing systemic surveillance of student social media data by 38 colleges across the country, revealing specific targeting of campus protestors and activists. The stories led two major colleges to end their use of the service and spawned a state legislative inquiry.
- Voted *The Dallas Morning News'* 2022 Investigative Reporter of the Year, in my first year on the job.
- Compiled the most comprehensive police discipline database in the country for an ongoing series on DPD failures.
- Revealed the surveillance of millions of Texas' students by their schools in a Sunday front-page story. This story won the Northern California Society of Professional Journalists James Madison Freedom of Information award.
- Wrote a Python script to assess the impacts of prison gerrymandering in Texas for a Sunday front-page story. This story was a runner-up for the 2023 Harry Frank Guggenheim Excellence in Criminal Justice Reporting Award.
- Routinely write code to scrape, parse, analyze, mine and visualize data for long-term and breaking news stories.

Pulitzer Center AI Accountability Fellowship

Fellow – June 2022 - September 2023.

- Given nearly $18,000 as part of the inaugural class of fellows to complete my investigation into Social Sentinel.
- Routinely contribute articles and give lectures to students and journalists on how to understand and cover AI.

NBC News

Freelance Contributor — August 2020; *Investigative Intern* – August 2019 - December 2019.

- Broke a story on QAnon's massive scope on Facebook using the platform's leaked internal data. This story likely led Facebook to change its policy and ban hundreds of the right-wing conspiracy's groups and pages from the platform.
- Co-authored a series about a senior State Department official who embellished her resume, which led her to resign.

UC Berkeley School of Journalism

Investigative Reporting Teaching Assistant – July 2021 - August 2021.

- Co-taught lectures on investigative reporting techniques with Pulitzer Prize-winning reporter Thomas Peele.

The Asheville *Citizen-Times*

Intern – June 2017 - August 2017.

- Wrote 60+ stories in ten weeks, more than a dozen of which made the front page.

Education

University of California - Berkeley

Master's in Journalism, Graduate Certificate in Applied Data Science – May 2022

University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill

Bachelor's in Journalism, Minor in Music – May 2020

Skills

Languages: Python, JavaScript, R; SQL (SQLite, BigQuery, PostgreSQL); HTML, CSS; Git; Spanish, Hindi.
Libraries: Pandas, Geopandas, Playwright, Selenium, PDFPlumber, SpaCy, Plotly, Sklearn, NLTK; D3, Deck GL, Mapbox GL, Leaflet, Vega-Lite; dplyr, LightRAG, Ollama.
Programs: AWS, GCP; QGIS, Carto, Tableau, Flourish, Datawrapper; Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Lightroom, InDesign; Sheets, Excel.